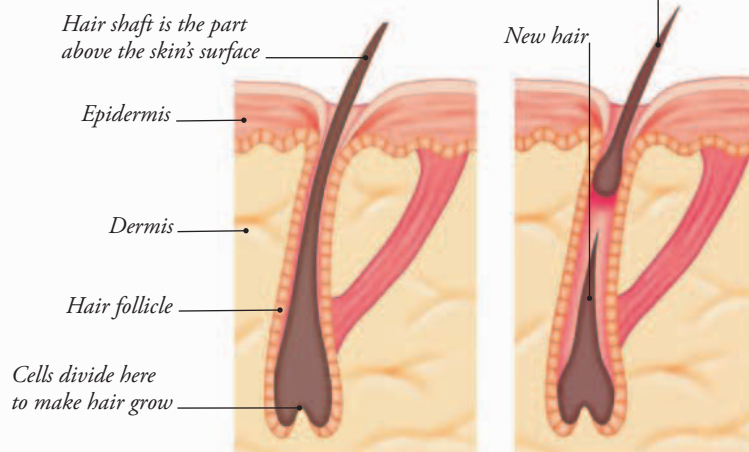




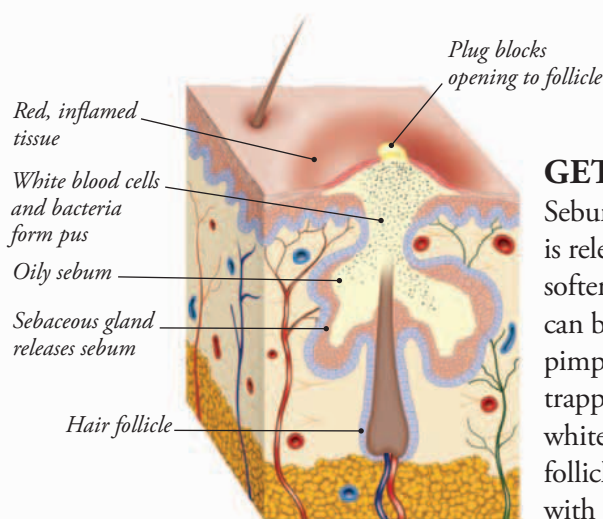
HOW HAIR GROWS

Each hair grows from a narrow hole called a follicle. At the hair's base, living cells divide, pushing upward to make the shaft longer. As they do so, cells fill with keratin and die. After a phase of growth, a hair is pushed out by its replacement.



▲ **SCALP HAIRS** Growing from its follicle (pink), this is one of the 100,000 hairs on the scalp. Scales on the outside of the hair overlap, just like roof tiles.

Each day, about 120 scalp hairs are lost and replaced.



GETTING PIMPLES

Sebum—the skin's natural oil—is released into hair follicles to soften hairs. But too much sebum can block hair follicles, causing pimples. Bacteria infecting the trapped sebum are attacked by white blood cells. This makes the follicle red, painful, and filled with creamy pus.

NAIL STRUCTURE

As this cutaway view shows, nails have a root, a body, and a free edge. Living cells in the matrix behind the root divide constantly. The new cells push the nail body forward, filling with keratin and dying as they do so. This makes the edge of the nail grow by about 0.11 in (3 mm) a month.

◀ **NAILS** Seen under a microscope, these are the dead, flattened cells that nails are made of. Packed with keratin, the cells form plates that interlock to make nails really hard.

